

Toddler Sleep Regression Survival — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

IDENTIFY THE REGRESSION

- ☐ **IDENTIFY THE REGRESSION:** Confirm your child previously slept well for at least 2 weeks before the disruption started, because regressions only happen when a solid sleep pattern existed first.
- ☐ **IDENTIFY THE REGRESSION:** Check whether your toddler is in a typical regression window (around 18 months, 2 years, or 2.5-3 years), because timing helps confirm this is developmental and temporary.
- ☐ **IDENTIFY THE REGRESSION:** Rule out illness, medication changes, or major life disruptions as causes of sleep issues, because these require different solutions than a standard regression.
- ☐ **IDENTIFY THE REGRESSION:** Notice if your child is actively working on new skills like climbing, talking in sentences, or problem-solving, because regressions often coincide with developmental leaps.

MAINTAIN THE BASELINE

- ☐ **MAINTAIN THE BASELINE:** Keep your existing bedtime routine exactly as it is and do not add new steps, because regressions are not the time to implement changes or new sleep associations.
- ☐ **MAINTAIN THE BASELINE:** Maintain a consistent wake time every single day, including weekends, because this is more important than bedtime control during regressions and prevents overtiredness.
- ☐ **MAINTAIN THE BASELINE:** Do not start extinction or cry-it-out sleep training during the regression, because your toddler is genuinely going through developmental changes that require support, not behavioral training.
- ☐ **MAINTAIN THE BASELINE:** Keep your blackout curtains and white noise machine in place, because maintaining a consistent sleep environment prevents additional disruption during this vulnerable period.

HANDLE NIGHT WAKINGS

- ☐ **HANDLE NIGHT WAKINGS:** Wait 5 minutes before responding to night wakings, because many regressions involve partial arousals where your toddler may resettle on their own if left undisturbed.
 - ☐ **HANDLE NIGHT WAKINGS:** Be patient when your toddler practices new skills at bedtime like climbing or talking, because their brain is processing these milestones during sleep and they are not trying to delay bedtime deliberately.
 - ☐ **HANDLE NIGHT WAKINGS:** Respond to night wakings more quickly than usual once you do engage, because shorter response times prevent full wakefulness and help avoid the overtired cycle that makes regressions worse.
 - ☐ **HANDLE NIGHT WAKINGS:** Call your doctor if the regression lasts more than 8 weeks without improvement, because prolonged sleep disruption could indicate sleep apnea or another condition requiring medical attention.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.